

The Worker: Hard work will get you everywhere.

The Creator: If you dream it, you can do it.

The Discerner: You can think your way to success.

The Relator: Success comes through collaboration.

In the next chapter you're going to figure out your own unique Money Type, and in the following chapters we'll look at the attributes of each Money Type and I'll show you how to curate great habits for your particular type. But before you dive in, I want to explain why Money Types are so important and what we're particularly looking at and for when we're seeking to understand our personal Money Type.

I'm doing this because, remember, I don't want this to just be a cute or fun read—I want it to be transformational for your finances.

When we look at Money Types, it's about not simply minimising our weaknesses but understanding and harnessing our strengths. Now, most of us understand we have innate weaknesses, especially when it comes to our finances, but we don't always recognise that we have strengths. I mean, if you identify as a spender or start to break out in hives at the thought of a budget, chances are you've already convinced yourself you're bad with money. The truth is you're not—you're just trying to work within a system that's broken and simply doesn't work for most of us. That's why, instead, it's about figuring out where your strengths lie and developing a system that's right for you.

Let me explain why identifying and working with our financial strengths is important, by looking at a speed-reading study completed by Don Clifton when he was a researcher at the University of Nebraska in the 1950s.

The research started with two groups of readers: one group who were gifted and able to read with comprehension at 350 words per minute, and a second group who were reading at around the average speed of 90 words per minute. The researchers decided to put both groups through the same speed-reading course to see what would happen. The group who were reading at 90 words per minute improved to about 150 words per minute with comprehension, or about a 66 per cent increase. The gifted group, meanwhile, didn't just improve by the average group's percentage; instead,